

CREEP

1. Passage anchor

> “Even now, I can still hear her voice in the back of my mind whenever I feel self-doubt **creeping in**.”

Passage meaning

creep in = begin to appear or affect someone slowly, quietly, and almost unnoticed

悄悄出現；逐漸侵入；不知不覺浮現

Here, **self-doubt creeping in** means that feelings of insecurity do not necessarily arrive suddenly. They gradually begin to enter the speaker's thoughts.

Practice

1. As the interview approached, nervousness began to **creep in**.

隨著面試逼近，緊張感開始**悄悄浮現**。

2. After several setbacks, a sense of doubt **crept in**.

經歷幾次挫折後，一種懷疑感**漸漸湧上心頭**。

Core meanings of CREEP

2. creep — move slowly and quietly

= move very slowly, carefully, and quietly, often to avoid being noticed

蹣手蹣腳地走；悄悄移動

Examples

1. She **crept downstairs** without making a sound.

她**蹣手蹣腳地下樓**，沒有發出聲音。

2. He **crept toward the door**.

他**悄悄地走向門口**。

This is one of the central literal meanings.

3. creep past / into / out of somewhere

= move quietly and carefully through or into a place

****悄悄經過 / 進入 / 離開****

Examples

1. The child ****crept into the room****.

那個孩子****悄悄走進房間****。

2. She ****crept out of the house**** before sunrise.

她在日出前****悄悄離開了房子****。

Movement close to the ground

4. creep — crawl or move close to the ground

= move slowly with the body close to the ground

****爬行；匍匐前進****

Examples

1. The insect ****crept across the floor****.

那隻昆蟲****爬過地板****。

2. A small animal was ****creeping through the grass****.

一隻小動物正在草叢中****緩慢爬行****。

For humans, ****crawl**** is usually the more ordinary word when moving on hands and knees.

5. creeping plant

= a plant that grows along the ground or another surface

****匍匐生長的植物；蔓生植物****

Examples

1. ****Creeping plants**** covered the wall.

****蔓生植物****覆蓋了牆面。

2. The garden path was surrounded by ****creeping vines****.

花園小徑周圍長滿了****蔓生藤蔓****。

Here, ****creep**** conveys slow spreading movement.

Gradual movement

6. creep — move or advance very slowly

= progress so slowly that the movement is barely noticeable

****緩慢移動；一點一點前進****

Examples

1. Traffic ****crept forward****.

車流****緩慢向前移動****。

2. The line ****crept toward the entrance****.

隊伍****一點一點地朝入口前進****。

No secrecy is required here; the main idea is extremely slow movement.

7. creep along

= move very slowly

****緩緩前進；慢慢移動****

Examples

1. The car ****crept along**** the icy road.

汽車在結冰的道路上****緩緩前進****。

2. We ****crept along**** in heavy traffic.

我們在嚴重塞車中****慢慢向前挪動****。

Gradual increase

8. creep up

= increase gradually and often almost unnoticed

****逐漸上升；慢慢增加****

Examples

1. Prices have been ****creeping up****.

價格一直在****慢慢上升****。

2. The temperature ****crept up**** during the afternoon.

下午氣溫****逐漸升高****。

Very useful in business, economics, data, and everyday descriptions.

9. creep higher / upward

= gradually become higher

****緩慢上升****

Examples

1. Costs continued to ****creep higher****.

成本持續****緩慢上升****。

2. Interest rates had ****crept upward**** over several months.

利率在數個月內****逐步上升****。

Gradual arrival of a feeling or condition

10. creep in

= gradually begin to appear, often unnoticed or unwanted

****悄悄出現；逐漸產生****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. A sense of uncertainty began to ****creep in****.

一種不確定感開始****悄悄浮現****。

2. Small errors can ****creep in**** when people are tired.

人們疲倦時，小錯誤可能會****不知不覺出現****。

11. doubt / fear / anxiety creeps in

= an unwanted emotion gradually begins to affect your thoughts

****懷疑 / 恐懼 / 焦慮逐漸湧現****

Examples

1. Fear began to ****creep in**** as darkness fell.

天色變暗時，恐懼開始****悄悄湧上心頭****。

2. Anxiety ****crept in**** while she waited for the results.

她等待結果時，焦慮感****逐漸浮現****。

This is a vivid personification: the feeling behaves as though it quietly enters a place.

12. errors creep in

= errors gradually or unintentionally become part of something

****錯誤逐漸混入；不知不覺出現錯誤****

Examples

1. Mistakes can ****creep in**** during repeated copying.

反覆抄寫時，錯誤可能****不知不覺混進去****。

2. Several inconsistencies had ****crept into the report****.

報告中已經****悄悄出現了****幾處不一致。

Very useful formal figurative use.

13. creep into something

= gradually enter, appear in, or become part of something

****逐漸進入；悄悄滲入****

Examples

1. Doubt ****crept into her mind****.

懷疑****悄悄進入她的腦海****。

2. Informal expressions gradually ****crept into his academic writing****.

非正式用語漸漸****混入他的學術寫作中****。

Gradual spreading

14. creep across / over something

= spread slowly across a surface or area

****慢慢蔓延；逐漸覆蓋****

Examples

1. Shadows ****crept across the room****.

陰影****慢慢延伸過房間****。

2. Fog ****crept over the hills****.

霧氣****逐漸籠罩山丘****。

Often literary or descriptive.

15. darkness creeps in

= darkness gradually develops or spreads

****夜色漸濃；黑暗逐漸降臨****

Examples

1. Darkness ****crept in**** as the sun disappeared.

太陽落下後，黑暗****逐漸降臨****。

2. Evening shadows ****crept across the valley****.

黃昏的陰影****慢慢籠罩山谷****。

Time

16. time creeps by / passes slowly

= time seems to pass extremely slowly

****時間過得很慢****

Examples

1. The hours ****crept by**** while we waited.

我們等待時，時間****過得異常緩慢****。

2. Time seemed to ****creep**** during the long meeting.

漫長會議期間，時間彷彿****過得特別慢****。

Physical sensation

17. something creeps over / through someone

= a sensation or emotion gradually spreads through the body

****一種感覺逐漸襲來 / 傳遍全身****

Examples

1. A cold feeling ****crept over me****.

一股寒意****慢慢襲上我全身****。

2. A strange sense of unease ****crept through him****.

一種奇怪的不安感****逐漸傳遍他全身****。

Often literary.

Noun: unpleasant person

18. creep — an unpleasant or disturbing person

= someone whose behavior makes others uncomfortable, especially because they seem intrusive, dishonest, or sexually inappropriate

****討厭的人；令人不舒服的人；怪人****

Examples

1. That guy is a ****creep****.

那傢伙真是個****令人反感的人****。

2. She thought he was acting like a ****creep****.

她覺得他的行為****很令人不舒服****。

Register

Informal and insulting.

This noun sense is completely different from the passage sense.

Noun: gradual movement

19. creep — gradual increase or spread

In compounds, **creep** can mean slow, often undesirable expansion or increase.

逐步增加；緩慢擴張

Examples include:

- * scope creep
- * cost creep
- * mission creep

These are especially common in professional contexts.

20. scope creep

= gradual expansion of a project beyond its original planned scope

範疇蔓延；專案範圍不斷擴張

Examples

1. The project suffered from serious **scope creep**.
這個專案出現嚴重的**範圍不斷擴張問題**。
2. Clear requirements can reduce **scope creep**.
清楚的需求規格可以減少**專案範疇蔓延**。

High-value business/project-management term.

21. mission creep

= gradual expansion of an activity or mission beyond its original purpose

任務範圍逐漸擴大；任務蔓延

Examples

1. Critics warned about **mission creep**.

批評者警告可能出現**任務範圍不斷擴大的情況**。

2. The organization tried to avoid **mission creep**.

該組織設法避免**任務不斷擴張**。

Formal and often used in policy, military, or organizational discussion.

Engineering / materials science

22. creep — gradual deformation under sustained stress

= slow permanent deformation of a material subjected to continuous stress, often at high temperature

潛變；蠕變

Examples

1. Engineers tested the metal for **creep** at high temperatures.

工程師測試金屬在高溫下的**潛變 / 蠕變**。

2. Long-term **creep** can weaken structural materials.

長期**蠕變**可能削弱結構材料。

This is a genuinely distinct technical meaning.

Common phrasal expressions

23. creep up on someone

A. approach someone quietly so they do not notice

悄悄靠近某人

1. The cat **crept up on** the bird.

那隻貓**悄悄靠近**小鳥。

B. gradually begin affecting someone without being noticed

不知不覺影響 / 來臨

2. Tiredness **crept up on me** during the afternoon.

下午時，疲倦感**不知不覺襲來**。

24. something creeps up on you

= something gradually develops until you suddenly notice it

某事不知不覺地發生 / 影響你

Examples

1. Age has a way of **creeping up on you**.
年齡常常會**在不知不覺中找上你**。
2. Stress can **creep up on you** if you never take breaks.
如果一直不休息，壓力可能會**不知不覺累積起來**。

25. creep someone out

= make someone feel uncomfortable, nervous, or disgusted

讓某人毛骨悚然；讓某人覺得很不舒服

Examples

1. That empty house **creeps me out**.
那棟空屋讓我覺得**毛毛的**。
2. His strange smile **creeped her out**.
他奇怪的笑容讓她覺得**很不舒服**。

Form note

In this phrasal verb, **creeped out** is common:

> It **creeped me out**.

even though the ordinary past tense of **creep** is usually **crept**.

Verb forms

26. creep – crept – crept

Standard major forms:

* creep
* creeps
* creeping
* **crept**
* **crept**

Examples

1. The cat **crept** toward the door.
那隻貓**悄悄走向門口**。
2. Doubt had **crept into** his mind.
懷疑已經**悄悄進入他的腦海**。

Spelling

creeping keeps the double **e**:

* creep → creeping

Related forms

27. creeping

A. moving slowly and quietly

悄悄移動的

B. gradually spreading or developing

逐漸發展的；慢慢蔓延的

Examples

1. A **creeping sense of fear** filled the room.
一種**逐漸加深的恐懼感**瀰漫開來。
2. They were concerned about **creeping costs**.
他們擔心成本**逐漸上升**。

28. creepy

= strange or frightening in a way that makes you uncomfortable

****令人毛骨悚然的；詭異的****

Examples

1. The abandoned building looked ****creepy**** at night.

那棟廢棄建築晚上看起來很****陰森詭異****。

2. He gave me a ****creepy feeling****.

他讓我有種****毛毛的不舒服感****。

Very common informal adjective.

29. creepiness

= the quality of being creepy

****陰森感；令人不舒服的詭異感****

Examples

1. The music adds to the film's ****creepiness****.

音樂加強了電影的****陰森感****。

2. There was an undeniable ****creepiness**** about the place.

那個地方有一種明顯的****詭異感****。

Key contrasts

30. creep vs crawl

****crawl****

= move on hands and knees, or with the body close to the ground

****爬行****

****creep****

= move slowly and quietly, often secretly or carefully

****悄悄移動；躡手躡腳****

Compare:

> The baby ****crawled**** across the floor.

> 嬰兒在地板上**爬行**。

> He **crept** across the room so nobody would hear him.

> 他為了不被人聽見而**躡手躡腳穿過房間**。

There is overlap for insects and small animals.

31. creep vs sneak

****sneak****

= move or act secretly, usually to avoid being noticed

****偷偷走；偷偷做****

****creep****

= move slowly and quietly, with emphasis on the manner of movement

****躡手躡腳地移動****

Compare:

> She **snuck out** without telling anyone.

> 她沒告訴任何人就**偷偷溜出去**。

> She **crept out** so quietly that nobody woke up.

> 她**躡手躡腳地出去**，沒有吵醒任何人。

32. creep vs tiptoe

****tiptoe****

= walk quietly on the front part of your feet

****踮著腳走****

****creep****

= move slowly and quietly more generally

Compare

> He **tiptoed past the sleeping baby**.

> 他**踮著腳**走過熟睡的嬰兒旁邊。

> He **crept past the door**.

> 他**悄悄走過門口**。

33. creep in vs appear

****appear****

= become visible or present

****出現****

****creep in****

= appear gradually, quietly, and often without being noticed

****悄悄浮現 ; 逐漸出現****

Compare:

> Doubt ****appeared****.

> 懷疑出現了。

> Doubt ****crept in****.

> 懷疑****悄悄地、不知不覺地浮現****。

The second is far more vivid.

34. creep up vs rise

****rise****

= increase or move upward

****上升****

****creep up****

= increase slowly and gradually, often almost unnoticed

****緩慢上升****

Compare:

> Prices ****rose**** by 20%.

> 價格上升了20%。

> Prices have been ****creeping up**** for months.

> 價格幾個月來一直****慢慢上漲****。

Meaning map

The central physical image of **creep** is:

slow, quiet movement that is difficult to notice

From that develop several branches:

Physical movement

creep through a room

→ **躡手躡腳地移動**

Ground movement

an insect creeps

→ **爬行**

Slow progress

traffic creeps forward

→ **緩慢前進**

Gradual increase

prices creep up

→ **逐步上升**

Unnoticed arrival

doubt creeps in

→ **悄悄浮現**

Gradual spread

shadows creep across the room

→ **逐漸蔓延**

Professional abstraction

scope creep

→ **範圍逐漸擴張**

The passage metaphor therefore preserves the core meaning very closely:

a person creeps quietly into a room

→ **self-doubt quietly enters the mind**

Passage recap

> “...whenever I feel self-doubt **creeping in**.”

Here:

creep in = **gradually and quietly begin to appear or affect someone**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **悄悄浮現** *

* **逐漸湧上心頭** *

* **不知不覺產生** *

* **慢慢侵入心中** *

Natural contextual translation:

每當我感覺自我懷疑悄悄浮上心頭時.....

MCQ-ready meaning

creep in in the passage

= **begin to appear gradually and almost unnoticed**

悄悄出現；逐漸產生；不知不覺浮現

It does not mean literal crawling here. The literal idea of **quiet, slow movement** has been transferred to the gradual arrival of an emotion.